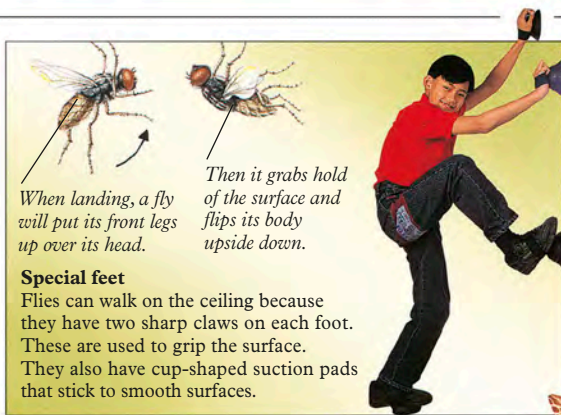




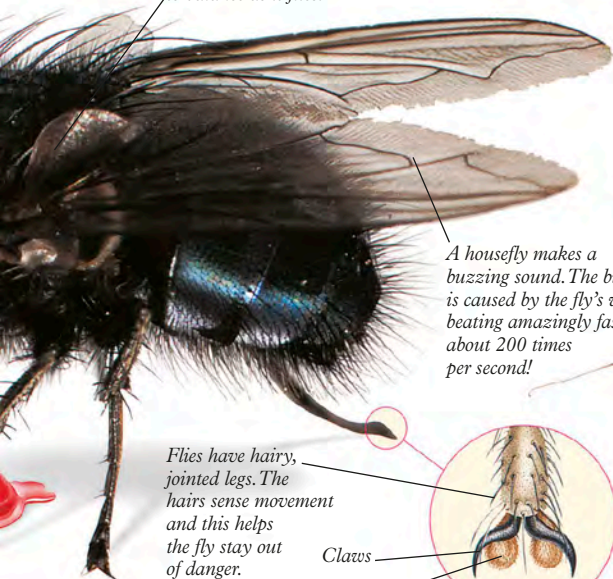
When landing, a fly will put its front legs up over its head.

Then it grabs hold of the surface and flips its body upside down.

Special feet

Flies can walk on the ceiling because they have two sharp claws on each foot. These are used to grip the surface. They also have cup-shaped suction pads that stick to smooth surfaces.

True flies don't have back wings. Instead they have little bumps which look like drumsticks. These are called halteres. They help the fly to balance as it flies.



A housefly makes a buzzing sound. The buzz is caused by the fly's wings beating amazingly fast—about 200 times per second!

Flies have hairy, jointed legs. The hairs sense movement and this helps the fly stay out of danger.

Claws

Suction pads

Flittering flies



South American mydas fly



Robber fly



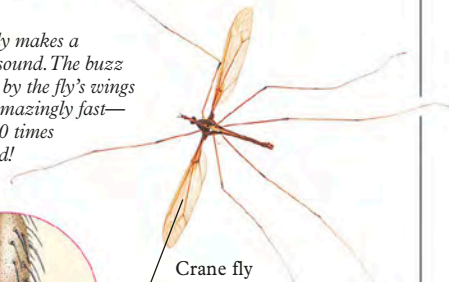
Hoverfly



Stalk-eyed fly



Horsefly



Crane fly

There are about 15,000 known types of crane fly in the world. In the UK, they are sometimes called daddy-longlegs.